PATERNITY LEAVE POLICY

2026-27

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Version	Date	Prepared By	Review / Finalized By	Approved by
0.1	30-Oct-2023	Renuka M	Radhika Rao	Sudhindra Haribhat
1.0	21-Nov-2023	Vaishnavi P	Radhika Rao	Sudhindra Haribhat
2.0	16-Dec-2024	Vaishnavi P	Radhika Rao	Prasad Patwa

The policy is effective from November 01, 2023

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Purpose:

This policy recognizes a father's role in child rearing while facilitating a balanced work life and promoting gender equality.

Scope:

This policy provides paid time off work to care for or make arrangements for the welfare of a child or dependent family member.

General Principles:

A male employee (including a probationer depending on the manager's approval) with less than two surviving children, may be granted paternity leave by an authority competent to grant leave for a period of five days, during the confinement of his wife for childbirth, i.e. up to two weeks before, or up to **six** months from the date of delivery of the child. The same is to be applied for through DarwinBox only.

If paternity leave is not availed of within the period specified, such leave shall be treated as lapsed.
During such period of 5 days, he shall be paid salary equal to the pay drawn immediately before proceeding on leave.
The paternity leave may be combined with leave of any other kind in case of emergencies.

This entire leave can be availed in a single duration of 5 days, at any time during the child's first six months after birth.

AutomationEdge reserves the right to seek any information and documents from the benefit-seeking Employee to satisfy itself that the above-mentioned conditions are being fulfilled.
Paternity Leave cannot under any circumstances be accrued, encased, or carried forward.
When multiple children (twins, triplets, etc.) are born (or expected), the Employee is eligible only for a maximum (5 days)of one period of paid leave with respect to such multiple births **or adoptions.**
AutomationEdge reserves the right to seek any information and documents from the benefit-seeking Employee to satisfy itself that the above-mentioned conditions are being fulfilled.

Guidelines for Employees –

If you wish to apply for Paternity Leave, you are expected to plan for the same in advance.
Ensure that your project / functional lead and team are informed at least 3 months in advance about your leave dates and make them aware of your application details.
Ensure that your leave dates are confirmed and submit the details at least 15 Days prior to starting your leave. Update your timesheets accordingly before you go on leave. Employees are expected to ensure a smooth transition of your responsibilities and deliverables.

Absence from Work

Any unexplained absence from work beyond the duration of your leave may result in appropriate disciplinary action (including termination), especially if you are absent from work for a continuous period of 5 days after the leave period has expired. Any explanation for your absence must be given in writing, citing reasons for not being able to communicate over phone, e-mail, or through any other mode with your colleagues or managers at AutomationEdge. AutomationEdge will have the discretion to accept (or not) the reasons given in such a written explanation.

No Prejudice to Statutory Rights

Nothing contained in this Policy shall prejudice any statutory right of any Employee.

Amendments to Policy and Benefits

We reserve the right, in our sole discretion, to amend any part of this Policy at any time for any reason, including to fully comply with applicable law in force in India.

We also reserve the right to review your application for benefits and provide different or alternative benefits at our sole discretion.

AutomationEdge may, at its discretion, seek any information or documents from the benefit-seeking Employee before approving leave, including the submission of a valid medical certificate signed by a registered medical practitioner.

*Note: The paternity leave shall not normally be refused under any circumstances

P.S. The Management reserves the right to amend existing policies from time to time or introduce new ones to facilitate a professional work culture in the Company. The same shall be communicated to all employees as and when such amendments are introduced.